

MyungJin Ko (Ray)

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Summary

Software engineer with 7 years of experience. As a startup co-founder, I led the design, development, and operation of the company's SaaS, growing it to roughly KRW 1B (~\$750K) in cumulative revenue at near-zero operating cost. Across B2B SaaS and mobile products I built from scratch, I handled peak traffic up to ~25K and ~KRW 200–300M ARR, working through multi-tenant architecture, real-time collaboration, and on-call in production. I care less about any single stack than about choosing the right tool for the problem and designing systems that stay simple and reliable as traffic and complexity grow — from shaping requirements and architecture decisions to building across the stack and operating what I ship. I've shipped in TypeScript, Rust, Java, and C# as each problem called for it, and lately leaned into AI-assisted development. I'm preparing for a next step, ideally helping build global products from zero to one.

Skills

- **Fluent:** TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL
- **Worked with:** Rust (Axum), Java / Spring, C# / .NET (Revit), React Native, Tauri, Python, Express, MySQL
- **Data & search:** PostgreSQL, Supabase, Elasticsearch
- **Infrastructure:** AWS (ECS, EC2, RDS, Lambda), Fly.io, Vercel, Cloudflare, Docker, NHN Cloud, CI/CD, Sentry, PostHog
- **Areas:** multi-tenant SaaS, real-time systems (CRDT), REST API design, performance optimization, 0-to-1 product

Experience

Plancy — Co-founder & Founding Engineer

Seoul, South Korea · May 2021 – Jun 2026

Plancy ran both a self-built SaaS and an event-agency web business for the MICE (events & exhibitions) industry. I led the engineering and infrastructure for both.

MICE All-in-One — B2B multi-tenant SaaS (mice.ai.kr) · Lead engineer · Feb 2024 – Jun 2026

- Built and ran the product as lead engineer of a 3-person team (a TPM on product/design and a junior engineer I mentored), from PoC to production — ~10 agency customers, run at near-zero operating cost.
- Powered large government-backed events (budgets over ~KRW 1B), handling traffic and complexity beyond what the revenue suggests; ranked it top-5 (from ~20th) in search via technical SEO, turning organic traffic into customers.
- Designed multi-tenant white-labeling: per-project JWT auth that unified three fragmented flows into one model, RLS tenant isolation, and one-click custom-domain provisioning (DNS + static deploy) via the Cloudflare API.
- Built a real-time collaborative document editor (TipTap + YJS / CRDT) with version history and offline support (IndexedDB).
- Optimized bulk document generation: admins generate per-attendee PDFs and emails on demand, in batches. Serverless (Next.js / Supabase Edge) hit timeout and memory limits, so I moved the generation path to Rust (Axum) with a dedicated Chromium worker pool — a strangler-fig migration on Docker/Fly.io — cutting batch time ~70% and removing timeouts on 100+ item jobs.
- Shipped a dynamic form builder (JSON Schema), business-matching with auto-scheduling, QR check-in with attendee tracking and segmentation, Toss Payments subscriptions, and an admin back-office for users, events, and billing.
- Ran CI/CD (GitHub Actions) with pre-commit/pre-push gates (Rust clippy, tests, ESLint) and Sentry/PostHog monitoring; turned direct customer requirements into shipped fixes and a prioritized roadmap. Drove an AI-assisted workflow (Cursor / Claude Code), and began building a RAG-based proposal (RFP) assistant and a streaming chat assistant on our event data.

Event Web & Registration Platforms — national institutions & large events · Technical Lead · Oct 2021 – Oct 2025

- Led technical delivery of websites and real-time registration platforms for national institutions and large events (e.g., National Hangeul Museum, Sculpture City Seoul), end-to-end from planning to operations, with a TPM and a junior engineer.
- Ran 20–30 events per year (each ~2,000 DAU at peak registration) over 3–4 years; templated the recurring event sites and registration flow to cut build time for new events.
- Owned the infrastructure and deployment setup, plus the team's internal dev environment, tooling, and workflow.

Client Engineering (outsourcing) · Software Engineer / Tech Lead · Oct 2021 – Oct 2025

- Delivered SI and prototype projects for enterprise clients (mostly 3–6 months each), adapting the stack and architecture per project — from frontend-only apps to serverless and full-stack systems.
- Solar-design review platform: built an Autodesk Revit add-in (C# / .NET) to extract BIM data, designed a custom file format (.pim, a ZIP of structured JSON), parsed it via Next.js into Supabase, and surfaced reports, charts, and national-standard compliance checks — an end-to-end desktop-CAD-to-web pipeline.
- Public-sector lookup system in Java / Spring on a CSAP-certified cloud (NHN Cloud) with PII encryption and access control.

The Scent Lab — Co-founder & Founding Engineer

Seoul, South Korea · Sep 2020 – May 2021

My first startup. I led product and frontend and built the server alongside a junior backend engineer I mentored.

- Built and launched an AI-assisted fragrance recommendation app (React Native / Expo) on iOS and Android.
- Designed a recommendation engine over a ~70K-item dataset (structured by scent notes) using Elasticsearch with weighted scoring, combined with survey-based personalization.
- Designed and deployed the NestJS backend as containers on AWS ECS.
- Co-filed a patent for the recommendation process; secured ~KRW 50M in Korean government startup funding.

Earlier Experience

- **Supaja — Frontend Lead (Freelance), Apr – Sep 2020** — Owned the whole frontend solo; onboarded a publisher-turned-React developer so it kept running after I left. Next.js, TypeScript.
- **Weplanet — Web Developer Intern, Mar – Aug 2019** — Prototyped client projects; built frontend (React) plus basic backends with Node/Express and MySQL.

Education

B.S. in Computer Science (Software) — Sahmyook University, Seoul, South Korea

Military Service

Republic of Korea Marine Corps — IT Operations Specialist · Sergeant, completed mandatory service · Feb 2014 – Nov 2015